STRIDE ISP 2.1 – GV.OC

Organizational Context

Version [2.0] Review

Purpose:

This policy underscores the vital role of Stride's mission in shaping cybersecurity risk management decisions. By seamlessly aligning cybersecurity strategies with the organization's mission, vision, and corporate objectives, Stride ensures that its technology and security initiatives actively drive and support its overarching goals.

Scope and Applicability

These policies and standards apply to all Stride-owned technology and business operations.

All workforce members and their respective facilities supporting Stride business operations, technology, or both, wherever Stride data is stored or processed, including any third-party contracted by Stride to handle, process, transmit, store, or dispose of Stride data are subject to the requirements of this document.

All data, systems, activities, and assets owned, leased, controlled, or used by Stride, its agents, contractors, or other business partners on behalf of Stride are within the scope of the requirements of this document.

The requirements outlined in this document apply where technically feasible and commercially reasonable, as determined by executive management. Any exceptions to these standards must be requested, using the approved workflow and remain documented until compliance has been achieved. Exceptions are only granted temporarily for periods of up to one calendar year.

Definitions

All definitions are located within Stride - ISP 1.2 – IT Policy Definitions.

Any inquiries regarding terminology or clarity may be directed to Stride's Information Security Team for assistance.

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Document Control

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This document will be reviewed at least annually and re-issued when revisions are necessary. Any changes introduced in the most recent version are itemized below. Obsolete copies should be destroyed or archived upon the release of the newest version.

Implementation and Compliance

All business units are required to comply with any changes applied to the most recent version of this publication within 90 days from the date of publication.

Change History

Version	Date of Change	Summary of Change(s)
1.0	6/15/2022	Initial Release and Publication
1.1	12/01/2022	- Added Change History - Updated and/or redacted language for clarity where necessary
1.2	03/17/2023	- Updated approvals section
1.3	01/01/2024	- Updated Purpose/Scope/Document Control/Implementation and Compliance - Changed formatting to new standard - Changed document images
2.0	01/28/2025	- Major change to align with NIST 2.0
2.0	02/24/2025	- Approved Mark Williams - CISO
2.0	02/27/2025	- Published

ORGANIZATIONAL CONTEXT STANDARDS

The circumstances — mission, stakeholder expectations, dependencies, and legal, regulatory, and contractual requirements — surrounding the organization's cybersecurity risk management decisions are understood.

GV.OC-01: Organizational Mission

Stride is committed to helping learners of all ages reach their full potential through inspired teaching and personalized learning. This mission drives every aspect of the organization, including cybersecurity risk management, ensuring alignment with stakeholder expectations, dependencies, and legal, regulatory, and contractual requirements.

Organizational Mission and Vision:

- Stride's mission, vision, and corporate strategy are clearly defined, documented, and communicated to all personnel.

- These guiding principles are shared through mission and vision statements, marketing efforts, and service strategies to ensure widespread understanding and alignment.

Communication and Engagement:

- Stride's mission is conveyed to learners, parents, school districts, boards of education, and policymakers to promote collaboration and input in shaping educational and cybersecurity strategies.

- All personnel are regularly informed of the mission and its relevance to their roles through formal communications and training.

Alignment of Cybersecurity Strategies:

- Stride's technology and cybersecurity strategies, architectures, and programs are formally governed to align with and support the organization's mission, objectives, and priorities.

- Tactical initiatives and cybersecurity risk profiles are evaluated to ensure they contribute to achieving the organization's goals.

Adaptability and Continuous Improvement:

- Stride's cybersecurity framework incorporates feedback and insights from stakeholders to adapt to evolving educational and technological needs.

- Regular reviews are conducted to ensure alignment between cybersecurity practices and the mission to provide personalized, effective learning opportunities.

References:

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-01.01
- SP 800-221A: GV.CT-5
- SP 800-221A: GV.CT-3
- CSF v1.1: ID.BE-2
- CSF v1.1: ID.BE-3

GV.OC-02: Stakeholder Expectations

Internal and external stakeholders are understood, and their needs and expectations regarding cybersecurity risk management are understood and considered.

Stakeholder Expectations:

- Internal and external stakeholders, including customers, employees, school districts, and policymakers—are identified, and their needs and expectations regarding cybersecurity risk management are understood and incorporated into the organization's strategies.
- Stride's risk management strategy and framework reflect its obligation to maintain safety and soundness while balancing the size and complexity of its operations.
- Risk appetite and tolerance statements are developed to foster a risk-aware culture that meets stakeholder expectations.
- All personnel are educated on the industry sector's legal and regulatory requirements to ensure compliance. Major changes in these requirements are communicated effectively throughout the organization.

Sector Interdependencies:

- Technology and cybersecurity risk management strategies identify and communicate Stride's role within the education sector as a component of critical infrastructure.

- Interdependencies with other critical infrastructure sectors, such as financial services and telecommunications, are identified, and associated risks are managed and communicated to ensure resilience and continuity.

Adaptability and Continuous Improvement:

- Stride's cybersecurity framework incorporates feedback and insights from stakeholders to adapt to evolving educational and technological needs.

- Regular reviews are conducted to ensure alignment between cybersecurity practices and the mission to provide personalized, effective learning opportunities.

References:

- SP 800-218: PO.2.1

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-02

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-02.01

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-02.02

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-02.03

- SP 800-221A: GV.OV-2

- SP 800-221A: GV.CT-2

- SP 800-221A: GV.CT-3

- CSF v1.1: ID.SC-2

- CSF v1.1: ID.GV-2

GV.OC-03: Legal, Regulatory, and Contractual Obligations

Stride is committed to understanding, managing, and adhering to all legal, regulatory, and contractual obligations regarding cybersecurity, including privacy and civil liberties requirements.

Standards:

Alignment with Legal and Regulatory Obligations:

- Strides technology and cybersecurity strategy, framework, and policies shall align with applicable legal, statutory, contractual, and regulatory obligations.
- Compliance responsibilities must be unambiguously assigned to appropriate roles or functions within the organization.

Policy Approval and Governance:

- Stride implements and maintains documented policies addressing customer data privacy.
- All policies related to customer data privacy are reviewed and approved by a designated officer or the organization's appropriate governing body, such as the Board of Directors or one of its committees.

Policy Maintenance and Review:

- Policies are regularly reviewed and updated to ensure continued compliance with evolving legal, regulatory, and contractual requirements.
- The organization maintains an audit trail of all reviews and updates to demonstrate compliance efforts.

Privacy and Civil Liberties:

- Stride ensures that its practices respect and protect customer privacy and civil liberties.
- Mechanisms are implemented to assess and mitigate privacy risks in new initiatives or changes to existing processes.

Compliance Monitoring:

- A process for monitoring compliance with legal, regulatory, and contractual requirements is established.
- Any non-compliance is promptly identified, addressed, and reported to the relevant governing body or designated officer.

Training and Awareness:

- Employees and contractors receive regular training on the organization's legal, regulatory, and contractual obligations, particularly in relation to cybersecurity and data privacy.

References:

- SP 800-218: PO.1.1
- SP 800-218: PO.1.2
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-03.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-03.02
- CSF v1.1: ID.GV-3

GV.OC-04: Stakeholder Dependencies

Stride identifies, thoroughly understands, and effectively communicates the critical objectives, capabilities, and services that stakeholders depend on or expect. This ensures clarity around stakeholder needs and expectations, enabling Stride to deliver on its commitments and maintain trust through consistent and transparent communication.

Standards:

- Stride maintains a comprehensive inventory of critical internal assets, business functions, and external dependencies, including detailed mappings to related assets, interconnected business functions, and information flows.

- Stride documents the essential business processes that are vital for delivering services and maintaining operations, along with the potential impacts on the organization if these processes are disrupted or fail to function properly.

- Stride establishes resilience requirements to ensure the delivery of critical services across all operating states, including during duress or attacks, recovery periods, and normal operations.

    - Resilience requirements ensure Stride can continue to function, protect critical data, and minimize damage or disruption during high-stress, security-compromised situations.

    - Focus on effective and timely recovery efforts to restore systems, services, or business operations affected by an attack, failure, or disruption.

    - Ensure consistent, reliable, and secure delivery of services under regular conditions, with safeguards to handle unexpected minor disruptions.

- Stride prioritizes the design, planning, testing, and monitoring of resilience for systems and other critical internal and external dependencies based on their importance to supporting business functions, advancing the enterprise mission, and ensuring stability.

References:

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-04
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-04.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-04.02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-04.03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-04.04
- SP 800-221A: MA.RI-1
- CSF v1.1: ID.BE-4
- CSF v1.1: ID.BE-5

GV.OC-05: Organizational Dependencies

Stride adopts a comprehensive approach to resilience and asset management, ensuring the organization's ability to deliver critical services and maintain operational continuity.

Standards:

Inventory of Key Assets and Dependencies:

- Stride maintains a detailed inventory of key internal assets, business functions, and external dependencies.
- This inventory includes mappings to:
    - Other assets within the organization.
    - Critical business functions and their interconnections.
    - Information flows that support operational and strategic goals.

Documentation of Critical Business Processes:

- Stride documents business processes that are essential for:
    - Delivering services effectively.
    - Supporting the organization’s mission and objectives.
- The documentation also assesses the potential impact on the business if:
    - Processes are degraded.
    - Processes fail to function as intended.

Establishment of Resilience Requirements:

- Resilience requirements are identified and defined to support critical services during various operating states, including:
    - Ensuring business continuity during incidents.
    - Enabling swift restoration of services.
    - Maintaining steady-state functionality.

Prioritization of Resilience Efforts:

- Stride prioritizes the resilience design, planning, testing, and monitoring of:
    - Systems critical to business operations.
    - Internal and external dependencies integral to delivering services.
- The prioritization is based on the criticality of these elements to:
    - Supported business functions.
    - Stride's overarching mission and objectives.
    - The financial services sector as a whole.

References:

- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-05
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-05.01
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-05.02
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-05.03
- CRI Profile v2.0: GV.OC-05.04
- SP 800-221A: GV.CT-5
- SP 800-221A: MA.RI-1
- CSF v1.1: ID.BE-1
- CSF v1.1: ID.BE-4